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SUPERSEDING
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FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CASE, FILING, TRANSFER, FIBERBOARD

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers fiberboard filing cases, metal reinforced, steel front, without drawer suspension.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Type and sizes.* The transfer cases covered by this specification shall be of one type and of the sizes indicated in table I, as specified (see 3.3 and 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-F-320—Fiberboard; Sheet, Stock and Cut Shapes.
PPP-T-45—Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 *Fiberboard.* Fiberboard shall conform to type CF; class, domestic; variety SW; and grade 200 or 275 as specified herein of PPP-F-320, except fiberboard shall be limited to B flute or C flute, at the option of the contractor, unless one of these

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flutes is specifically required in the invitation for bids, contract, or order (see 6.2).

3.1.2 *Tape.*

3.1.2.1 *Tape, gummed, paper, reinforced.* Gummed paper tape shall conform to type I or II or PPP-T-45.

3.1.2.2 *Tape, gummed, cloth.* Gummed cloth tape 2 inches wide shall have a tearing strength of not less than 40 Elmendorf units (direct machine reading); tape 3 inches wide shall have a tearing strength of not less than 70 Elmendorf units (direct machine reading). (See 4.4.2.)

3.1.3 *Metal.*

3.1.3.1 *Metal, for reinforcement of the transfer case* shall be of such quality and thickness as to provide sufficient strength and stability to meet the requirements of this specification.

3.1.3.2 *Metal, for drawer front of the transfer case* shall be of not less than 28-gage (0.0149-inch) sheet steel.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 *Case body.* The case body shall be constructed from one piece of grade 275 fiberboard and scored to form an open-end box. The body joint shall be along one of the four edges, perpendicular to the open end. Direction of flutes shall run perpendicular to the body joint. The body joint (manufacturer's joint) shall be either lapped or butted, at the option of the contractor. If a lapped joint, one edge of the fiberboard shall overlap inside the adjacent edge not less than 1-1/4 inches, and shall be secured by glue or adhesive forming a bond over the entire area of contact of the joint. If a butted joint, the edges shall be secured with gummed tape as specified in 3.1.2.1 or 3.1.2.2 not less than 3 inches wide. The gummed tape shall be well centered on the joint, shall extend the entire length of the joint, and shall adhere over the entire area in contact with the fiberboard.

The closed end of the case body shall have four flaps, or an interlocking closure. If closed by flaps, those along the longer edge shall be the outer flaps, and those along the shorter edge shall be the inner flaps. Flaps shall not project beyond an edge of the case. All flaps shall be equal in length, and the outer flaps shall meet when closed. Gummed tape as specified in 3.1.2.1 or 3.1.2.2, not less than 2 inches wide and 21 inches long, shall be provided for securing the flaps of the letter size case, and not less than 2 inches wide and 24 inches long for securing the flaps of the legal size case. If an interlocking closure is used, it shall be constructed in such a manner as to prevent accidental opening while in use.

The case body shall be reinforced with metal, or with a combination of metal and other suitable material, in such a manner as to provide sufficient strength and stability to withstand the weight-support test specified in 4.4.1, without buckling or sagging. When tested as specified in 4.4.1, the drawer of each of the two bottom cases shall operate easily without binding or jamming.

The open end of the case body shall have a metal edging which attaches securely to the fiberboard so that when the transfer cases are stacked and the drawers are in place the entire exposed front is metal covered.

3.2.2 *Interlocking.* Metal device(s) shall be provided with each transfer case for interlocking the cases when stacking them on top of the other, and for securing the cases side by side when stacking them into a multiple rack of files. The interlocking devices(s) shall be designed to permit easy erection or disassembly of the rack of files.

3.2.3 *Drawer.* The drawer body shall be constructed from fiberboard forming a bottom, two sides, and two ends. The drawer front shall be covered with not less than 28-gage (0.0149-inch) sheet steel. The assembled drawer shall fit snugly into the case body and completely close the open

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end. Each drawer shall have a drawer pull securely fastened to the drawer front, and a label holder which shall readily accommodate a label card not less than 2-15/16 inches by 1-1/2 inches. The sides, front, and back shall be reinforced with metal, or shall be two or more thicknesses of fiberboard. If single thickness, fiberboard shall be grade 275. If two or more thicknesses, fiberboard shall be not less than grade 200. The drawer back shall have an opening placed near the top center of sufficient size to permit gripping for lifting the drawer when heavily loaded.

3.2.4 *Base platform.* When specified, a base platform shall be supplied for each size case listed in 3.3 (see 6.2). The base shall be metal and shall have sufficient strength to support at least 10 filled transfer cases when interlocked in place. The base shall be sufficiently flanged to prevent marring of floors.

3.3 Sizes. The inside dimensions of the filing case drawer shall be as shown in table I.

TABLE I.—*Sizes*[1]

	Height	Depth	Width
Letter size (inches) .	10-3/8	24	12-1/4
Legal size (inches) ..	10-3/8	24	15-1/4

[1] A plus or minus tolerance of 1/4 inch in size will be permitted.

3.4 **Identification marking.** Each transfer case shall be permanently and legibly identified with the name or trade-mark of the manufacturer.

3.5 **Instruction data.** An instruction data sheet outlining the steps for assembling the transfer case shall be provided with each case.

3.6 **Color and finish.** Finish shall be in accordance with standard commercial practice. Color of outside of case and all metal parts shall be gray.

3.7 **Workmanship.** All exposed metal edges shall be rounded or smoothed to avoid sharp cutting edges. Transfer filing cases shall be free from any defects or imperfections which affect the appearance or which might impair serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 **Supplier's responsibility.** Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specifications where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 **Size of lot.** A lot shall consist of all transfer cases of one size offered for delivery at one time.

4.3 **Sampling.** Sampling shall be performed according to the procedures prescribed by MIL-STD-105. The normal inspection levels and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) shall be as follows:

Reference	Inspection levels	AQL's	
		Major	Minor
4.3.1	I	4.0	—
4.3.2	II	2.5	4.0

The indicated sample sizes shall be inspected for freedom from applicable defects listed in table II. If the acceptance number for any sample size is exceeded, the lot shall be rejected.

4.3.1 *Sampling and examination of shipping containers.* Packed and marked shipping containers shall be examined for compliance with the requirements of section 5. The sample unit shall be one shipping container.

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4.3.2 *Sampling for examination of visual, dimensional, and workmanship properties of end item.* A random sample of transfer cases shall be selected from shipping containers examined in accordance with 4.3.1. The sample size shall be examined for freedom of defects listed in table II. The sample unit shall be one transfer case.

4.3.3 *Sampling for tests.* Three transfer cases shall be taken at random from sample size of 4.3.2 for tests.

TABLE II.—*Classification of defects*

Defects	Category	
	Major	*Minor*
Packing not as specified	X	
Marking for shipment not as specified	X	
Transfer case not as specified	X	
Case body:		
Back end closure not as specified	X	
Tape for closure of back end not provided		X
Body joint not as specified	X	
Not one-piece construction	X	
No metal rim on front edge	X	
Not reinforced as specified	X	
Drawer:		
Fits loosely in case body	X	
Does not completely close open end of case body	X	
Front not metal covered	X	
Metal front less than 28 gage (0.0149 inch)	X	
Drawer pull missing	X	
Label holder missing	X	
Sides and back not reinforced	X	
Hand opening not provided in back end	X	
Interlocking device(s) not provided	X	
Dimensions not within tolerance	X	
Identification marking not as specified	X	
Instruction data not provided		X
Color not as specified	X	
Workmanship:		
Metal edges not rounded or smooth	X	
Defects which impair serviceability	X	
Affect appearance		X

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 *Weight-support test.* Stack and interlock sample cases three high on a flat surface. Place an 18- by 28-inch sheet of 3/4-inch plywood lengthwise on top of the stack. Then place 600 pounds in weights, evenly distributed, on top of the plywood. Open and close the drawers of the two bottom cases and examine for compliance with 3.2.1.

4.4.2 *Tearing test for gummed-cloth tape.*

4.4.2.1 *Apparatus (Elmendorf tester).* The tearing test apparatus consists essentially of a stationary jaw, a movable jaw carried by a pendulum (preferably in the shape of a sector carrying a graduated scale), a slitting device, and a device for registering tearing force. With the pendulum in position ready for test, the two jaws shall be separated by an interval of 2.5 millimeters (0.10 inch) and shall be in line so that the specimen clamped in them lies in a plane perpendicular to the plane of oscillation of the pendulum and so that the tops of the jaws are in a horizontal line. The slitting device shall be so arranged as to cut an initial slit in the specimen halfway between the 2 jaws and extending from the lower edge of the specimen to a distance of 4 millimeters (0.16 inch) above the top of the jaw.

4.4.2.2 *Preparation.* Specimens for test shall be cut so as to tear the crosswise (filler) threads and shall be of such width (vertical direction when placed in clamps) as to extend 4.3 centimeters (1.69 inches) above the apex of the initial slit. A single sheet of cloth tape shall be torn at a time and the results shall be expressed in units (direct machine reading).

4.4.2.3 *Determination.* The tearing strength of the gummed-cloth tape shall be determined as follows: Test specimen shall be so placed in the jaws as to rest evenly on their bottom plates and so as to extend a

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distance of not less than 2.5 centimeters (1 inch) into the movable jaw. Sector stop shall be released sharply in operating the instrument. Readings obtained when the test deviates more than 10 millimeters (3/8 inch) from the line of initial slit shall be rejected. Not less than five tests shall be made.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement the definitions and application of levels of packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.

5.1 **Packing.** Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.* The transfer cases shall be packed unassembled, in boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class 2, V3c. The boxes shall be waterproof, sealed with tape, and reinforced with bands of filament tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 *Level B.* Six transfer cases shall be packed unassembled, in a snug-fitting corrugated or solid fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, type I or II, class 1. Burst test of fiberboard shall be not less than 175 pounds per square inch. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.3 *Level C.* Unless otherwise specified, transfer cases shall be packed in new shipping containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, in a manner that will insure acceptance by common carrier and safe delivery at destination. Shipping containers shall comply with the carrier rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2 **Marking.**

5.2.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123, including size of commodity contained.

5.2.2 *Military agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use.** The transfer cases covered in this specification are intended for use in the transfer or storage of active or semi-active records, documents, letters, etc.

6.2 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein (see 3.1.1 and 5.1.3) and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Number of bases, if required, and size of case with which it will be used (see 3.2.4).

(*c*) Size of transfer case required (see 3.3).

(*d*) Inspection responsibility if other than as specified herein, and administrative provisions for inspection records, when applicable (see 4.1).

(*e*) Level of packing and any special marking for shipment required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Federal specifications do not include all types, classes, grades, etc. of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

6.4 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they

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should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.5 **Transportation data.** Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Filing Cases, steel and fiberboard combined, K.D.
Carload minimum weights:
In cars 40 ft. 9 in. or less in length, inside measurements: 10,000, 12,000, 15,000, 18,000, 22,000, and 30,000 pounds.
In cars exceeding 40 ft. 9 in. in length, inside measurements: 16,000, 18,000, 21,000, 24,000, 30,000 and 40,000 pounds.

Motor:

Filing Cases, not otherwise indexed, K. D.
Truckload minimum weights: 10,000. 12,000, 15,000, 18,000, 20,000 and 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

DOD coordination has been waived.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

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